Sanitary Pad Dispenser

Operating Manual • a simple guide to using and looking after the machine. No technical knowledge needed.

Service contact: _____ (write the phone number printed on the machine here)

1. What the machine does

It sells one sanitary pad for **KSh 20**. A customer puts coins in, the screen shows what they have paid, and when it reaches KSh 20 a pad drops out for them to collect.

It takes **KSh 5, 10, 20 and 40 coins**. It does **not give change** and **cannot give money back** — so it only ever takes payment once a pad is on its way, and any overpayment stays on the screen as credit toward the next pad.

2. For the customer — how to buy a pad

1. **Put a coin in the slot.** The screen shows your total so far.
2. **Keep adding coins** until you reach KSh 20 — any mix: four 5s, two 10s, one 20, or one 40.
3. At KSh 20 the screen says **KSH 20 - PAID!** and a pad comes out. Take it when it says **PLEASE COLLECT YOUR PAD**.
4. A **KSh 40** coin buys **two pads**, one after the other.

If you pay part and walk away, the machine keeps asking for about two minutes (a countdown on screen), then clears it.

3. What the screen is saying

The screen is 2 lines. A long message moves through a few pages — wait and it repeats. The two lines of a message are shown below separated by a slash.

Normal — everything fine

The screen shows	What it means
`PAD = KSH 20 / INSERT A COIN - THIS MACHINE TAKES KSH 5 10 20 OR 40`	Ready and waiting. Put a coin in.
`THAT IS KSH 5! / TOTAL KSH 5`	It received your coin; this is your total so far.
`ADD KSH 15 MORE / TIME LEFT 1:58`	Not enough yet. Add the rest before the timer runs out.
`KSH 20 - PAID! / A FULL PAD!`	Paid in full. A pad is coming.
`KSH 40 - PAID! / 2 PADS COMING!`	Paid for two pads.
`HERE IT COMES...`	The pad is being pushed out now.
`PLEASE COLLECT / YOUR PAD :)`	Take your pad.
`ONE MORE COMING / PAD 2 OF 2`	The second pad (after a KSh 40) is on its way.
`THANK YOU! / HAVE A GOOD DAY`	Finished.
`PLEASE WAIT / CREDIT KSH 5`	A coin arrived while a pad was dispensing; it is held for the next pad.

Things to act on

The screen shows	What it means	What to do
`COIN NOT TAKEN / THIS MACHINE TAKES KSH 5 10 20 OR 40`	An unrecognised coin was returned.	Use a 5, 10, 20 or 40 coin.
`SORRY - NO PADS / COIN SLOT CLOSED - PLEASE COME BACK LATER`	Out of pads. Not taking money.	Staff: refill the coil (sec. 6). It restarts by itself.
`SORRY - NO PADS / YOUR KSH 5 IS SAFE AND WAITING FOR YOU`	Out of pads, a part-payment is saved.	Refill; the saved credit then buys a pad.
`PAID - NO PAD / HOLD THE BUTTON FOR 1 SECOND TO TRY AGAIN`	Paid but no pad came out. Money safe.	Hold the front button 1 second to retry.
`SORRY - JAMMED (+ phone number)`	No pad after several tries.	Staff needed (sec. 7). Customer calls the number.
`OUT OF ORDER / CALL THE NUMBER ABOVE`	A fault; coin slot shut. Taking no money.	Staff: see section 7.
`CHUTE BLOCKED / PLEASE CLEAR THE CHUTE THEN HOLD THE BUTTON AGAIN`	Something in the chute, or sensor covered.	Staff: clear the chute, hold the button.
`PAD IS PAID FOR / PRESS THE BUTTON TO COLLECT IT`	After a power cut, a paid pad is waiting.	Press the front button (or insert a coin).

Key point for customers: if the screen says SORRY or OUT OF ORDER, the machine has stopped taking money. Nobody is charged for a pad that does not come out.

4. Switching on

- Plug in the **12 V power adapter**. The screen lights, shows `PAD DISPENSER / FIRMWARE v2.0` briefly, runs a quick self-check, then `PAD = KSH 20`.
- The backlight **dims after 2 minutes** when idle; a coin or button press wakes it. The writing stays readable in the dark — normal, and it saves power.

5. If the power goes out

No money is ever lost to a power cut. The machine saves what a customer has paid and remembers it when the power returns:

- **Paid in full** for a pad not yet dropped: it comes back to `PAD IS PAID FOR / PRESS THE BUTTON TO COLLECT IT`. A button press or a coin releases the pad.
- **Part-paid** (under KSh 20): the amount is remembered and the two-minute countdown starts again from when the power returns.

The countdown: when someone part-pays and stops, the machine keeps asking (`ADD KSH 15 MORE / TIME LEFT 1:58`) for about two minutes, then clears it. Those coins are already in the cash box and cannot be returned, which is why the machine only ever asks for small top-ups before timing out.

6. For the attendant — refilling pads

1. Open the machine with the key.
2. **Load pads into the coil from the front (the dropping end) first**, filling toward the back. Keep the front slots full — that is what makes each pad come out quickly.
3. Close and lock the machine.
4. It returns to service on its own — `SORRY - NO PADS` changes back to `PAD = KSH 20` once it senses pads.

Do not leave only one or two pads at the far back of the coil. A pad far from the front takes a long time to wind forward and may be reported as a jam. Keep the front filled.

7. When it says OUT OF ORDER or JAMMED — what to check

The machine shuts the coin slot whenever it cannot do its job, so no money is taken while it is faulted.

Easy fix for a jam first: open the machine, clear whatever is stuck, then **lift the pads out of the coil and put them back**. The machine treats that as a service visit, returns to work on its own, and dispenses any pad it owed. No tools needed.

If that does not do it, check in order:

Check	How
Is a pad stuck in the chute?	Look down the chute where the pad drops. Clear anything caught.
Is the coil jammed?	Turn the coil by hand (power off). It should move freely.
Is the drop sensor in place?	It sits across the chute. If its wire is knocked loose or the beam is blocked, the screen says CHECK SENSOR. Reseat the wire and clear the chute; it fixes itself once clear.
Are pads actually loaded?	SORRY - NO PADS just means refill (section 6).

To force it back into service after fixing the problem: hold the front button 1 second; or lift the pads out and back; or press the small RESET button inside (the screen restarts, any paid money is remembered and the pad held). A customer's paid-for pad is **never lost** to a reset or a fault — it waits until collected.

8. Quick problem guide

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Screen is blank	No power, or a rare start-up hiccup	Check the 12 V adapter. Press the RESET button inside. If it comes up on its own in a few seconds, that is the machine recovering.
Screen lit but writing never changes	Rare	Press the RESET button inside.
Strange / jumbled characters on screen	A rare electrical glitch	Switch the power off and on; it clears. It has not happened since the wiring was tidied — tell the service contact if you ever see it.
Coins come straight back out	Coin not recognised, or slot closed (no pads / faulted)	Use a 5/10/20/40 coin. If every coin returns, check the screen — probably SORRY - NO PADS or OUT OF ORDER.
Paid, no pad came out	A slow or stuck pad	Customer holds the front button 1 second to retry. If it keeps failing, staff clear the jam (section 7).
Keeps saying JAMMED after refilling	Pads loaded only at the far back	Refill from the front (section 6).
Machine restarted by itself	It caught an internal problem and recovered	Normal safety behaviour. If frequent, note it and call the service contact.

9. Good habits

- **Keep the coil filled from the front.**
- **Empty the coin box regularly.**
- Keep the chute and the drop sensor clean and clear.

- Switch the power off before unplugging the coin acceptor connector.
- If a fault keeps coming back, write down exactly what the screen said and call the service contact — that message is the fastest way to find the cause.

This machine takes payment only once a pad is on its way, and can never return coins. If a customer is ever owed a pad it could not deliver, the money stays saved and the pad is given when the machine is working again.